

Emergency Triage

If someone is unconscious and not breathing normally — gasping or not breathing at all — start CPR immediately.

[Open CPR guide →](#)

What do you see?

☹️ Can't breathe, speak, or cough

Person is clutching their throat, turning blue, or making high-pitched sounds.

[Choking guide →](#)

Heavy bleeding

Blood is spurting, pooling, soaking through bandages, or the limb is severed.

[Severe Bleeding guide →](#)

Sudden face droop, arm weakness, slurred speech

Or sudden severe headache, confusion, trouble seeing, or loss of balance.

[Stroke guide →](#)

Blue lips, tiny pupils, not breathing

After possible opioid use. May respond to naloxone (Narcan).

[Opioid Overdose guide →](#)

Confusion, fainting, very hot skin

In hot weather or after exertion. Could be heat stroke.

[Extreme Heat guide →](#)

Coughing, chest tightness, smoky air

During a wildfire or heavy air pollution. Vulnerable people at highest risk.

[Wildfire Smoke guide →](#)

Vomiting, diarrhea, very thirsty, dark urine

Signs of dehydration. Especially dangerous for children and older adults.

[Dehydration & ORS guide →](#)

Burn from fire, hot liquid, or chemical

Cool with running water, cover loosely, do not use ice or butter.

[Burns guide →](#)

✂ **Rigid jerking, loss of consciousness**

Seizure. Protect the head, time it, do not restrain or put anything in the mouth.

Seizure guide →

General first steps for any emergency

- 1 Check safety.** Make sure the scene is safe for you before approaching.
- 2 Check responsiveness.** Tap their shoulder and shout. No response + not breathing normally → CPR.
- 3 Call for help.** Call your local emergency number. Put the phone on speaker so the dispatcher can guide you.
- 4 Follow the guide above** that matches what you see.

This is a quick-reference aid, not a substitute for first-aid training. Always call your local emergency number in a life-threatening situation. Verify guidance against your local health authority.

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